

THE ROUTE

A 12-day journey through the Swiss Alps and Italian heartland — meticulously planned with every train, meal, museum ticket, and sunset accounted for.

12

DAYS

8

CITIES

11

NIGHTS

2

TRAVELERS

3

HOTELS BOOKED

✈️2

FLIGHTS BOOKED

□□

HALF FARE CARD

□□

ITALY UNPLANNED

Executive Trip Dashboard

→ Outbound Flight

SWISS LX155

BOM 00:40 → ZRH 06:20 · Oct 1

Dur: 9h 10m · PNR: **Z5DY9C**

Ticket: 7242907276239/40

Total: ₹77,625 (2 pax)

→ Return Flight

Gulf Air GF26 → GF56

FCO 12:40 → BAH 19:20 → BOM 05:10+1 · Oct 12

Layover BAH: 22:45-02:35 · PNR: **UYWIKY**

Ticket: 0724857463386/7 · Total: ₹69,372 (2 pax)

☐ Booked Hotels

Oct 1: **INSIDE FIVE**, Zurich — ₹12,375 ☐

Oct 2: **Hotel Alpina**, Lucerne — ₹18,748 ☐

Oct 3: **Harder Minerva**, Interlaken — ₹21,562 ☐

Total spent: ₹2,04,183

☐ Critical Dates

Late Jun/Jul: Last Supper ticket

Jul: EC 61 + Frecciarossa bookings

Aug-Sep: Uffizi, Accademia, Dome, Vatican, Borghese

Sep: Colosseum, HFC purchase

Master Route Outline

DATE	DAY	CITY	COUNTRY	KEY ACTIVITY	NIGHT
Oct 1	Thu	☐☐ Zurich	Switzerland	LX155 lands 06:20 · Old Town walk · Sprüngli	INSIDE FIVE
Oct 2	Fri	☐☐ Lucerne	Switzerland	Chapel Bridge · Lake cruise · Pilatus (opt)	Hotel Alpina
Oct 3	Sat	☐☐ Interlaken	Switzerland	☐ Jungfrauoch 3h · Sphinx · Ice Palace	Harder Minerva
Oct 4	Sun	☐☐ Milan	Italy	☐ Last Supper 15:00 · Duomo rooftop	TBD
Oct 5	Mon	☐☐ Cinque Terre	Italy	Train Milan → Monterosso · Beach or hike	TBD
Oct 6	Tue	☐☐ Florence	Italy	CT → Firenze · Santa Croce · Piazzale sunset	TBD
Oct 7	Wed	☐☐ Florence	Italy	Uffizi 08:15 · Accademia · Dome · Oltrarno	Same hotel
Oct 8	Thu	☐☐ Siena → Rome	Italy	Bus to Siena · Duomo · Frecciarossa 16:00	TBD
Oct 9	Fri	☐☐ Vatican City	Vatican	St. Peter's 07:00 · Dome · Museums 13:00	Same hotel
Oct 10	Sat	☐ Ancient Rome	Italy	Colosseum 08:30 · Forum · Borghese 15:00	Same hotel
Oct 11	Sun	☐☐ Rome Relaxed	Italy	Trevi morning · Aventine Keyhole · Final dinner	Same hotel
Oct 12	Mon	→ Depart	—	Leonardo Express 09:20 · GF26 12:40 FCO → BOM	—

Pre-Departure Prep

Weather & Packing

City	Daytime	Night	Packing Essentials
Zurich	~14°C	~7°C	Light jacket, sweater, comfortable walking shoes, umbrella
Lucerne	~15°C	~8°C	Layers, windbreaker (lake breeze), scarf
Interlaken/Jungfrauoch	~14°C / ☐ -5°C (summit)	~6°C	Warm layers! Thermal base, fleece, windproof jacket, gloves, beanie, sunglasses (snow glare)
Milan	~18°C	~10°C	Light jacket, comfortable shoes (lots of walking), smart casual for dinner
Cinque Terre	~20°C	~14°C	Walking/hiking shoes (for Blue Trail), swimsuit (if beach), light layers
Florence	~19°C	~11°C	Walking shoes (cobblestones), shoulders/knees covered for churches, jacket
Rome	~21°C	~13°C	Walking shoes (cobblestones + Roman ruins), church dress code, light jacket

⚠ **Jungfrauoch is the key:** It will be -5°C to 5°C at 3,454m even in October. Bring gloves, beanie, and a proper jacket. The rest of the trip is mild autumn weather.

Essential Apps to Download

SBB Mobile

☐☐ — Swiss train tickets, live departures, platform info, half-price tickets. Load HFC QR here.

Trenitalia

☐☐ — Italian train tickets, Frecciarossa, regional train validation

Google Maps

— Download offline maps for all 4 Italian cities + Swiss cities (spotty data in mountains)

Omio/Trainline

— Backup for train booking (often cheaper for advance purchase)

Uber/FREENOW

— Rome/Milan ride-hailing (use only white taxis with meters otherwise)

XE Currency

— CHF/EUR-INR conversion (CHF ~₹94, EUR ~₹91 as of May 2026)

Airbnb/Booking.com

— Your existing bookings live here

eSIM & Connectivity

Switzerland:

Swisscom prepaid eSIM (day pass ~CHF 10-15) or Airalo Switzerland eSIM (~\$12/1GB). CH is NOT in EU — separate plan needed!

Italy:

Vodafone Italy eSIM (via Airalo ~\$10/1GB), TIM, or Iliad. Italy IS in EU — works across all cities.

Recommended:

Airalo Europe eSIM covers Italy. Separate Switzerland eSIM for CH days. Install before departure. Both activate with QR codes.

Free WiFi:

Most Swiss stations (SBB Free WiFi), Italian museums/hotels, McDonald's

Tipping & Currency

☐☐ Switzerland (CHF ~₹94):

Service included in bills. Round up to nearest franc for good service. Tipping 5-10% NOT expected but appreciated. No tip culture like US.

☐☐ Italy (EUR ~₹91):

Service charge (coperto) is included. No tip required, but leaving €1-2 for good service or rounding up is fine. For tour guides: €5-10 if you enjoyed it.

ATMs:

Withdraw CHF from SwissPost or UBS ATMs. Withdraw EUR from Italian bank ATMs (avoid Euronet — high fees).

Cards:

Switzerland accepts cards everywhere (even small purchases). Italy: cards accepted in most places but carry €100-200 cash for small shops, market stalls, and some trattorias.

⚠ Fee warning:

When paying by card in EUR, ALWAYS choose to pay in EUR (not INR/home currency) — dynamic currency conversion has terrible rates.

Quick Reference

☐☐ Switzerland Emergency:

112 (general), 117 (police), 118 (fire), 144 (ambulance)

☐☐ Italy Emergency:

112 (general EU), 113 (police), 115 (fire), 118 (ambulance)

☐☐ Indian Embassy Bern:

+41 31 351 11 40

☐☐ Indian Embassy Rome:

+39 06 488 4642

☐☐☐ Travel Insurance:

⚠ Ensure you have comprehensive travel insurance covering medical evacuation, trip cancellation, and baggage loss. Keep policy number and 24h helpline on phone.

☐ Lost cards:

SBI/CICI/HDFC 24h helplines saved in phone. Carry backup cash in separate location.

Complete Booking Timeline

Prio	Item	Details	Book By	Cost	Link
URGENT	☐ Last Supper	Oct 4, 15:00 slot	Late Jun/Jul	€15	cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it
Jul	☐ EC 61 Interlaken → Milan	09:33-12:48	Jul 2026	From €23	trenitalia.com
Jul	☐ Frecciarossa Florence → Rome	16:00-17:28	Jul 2026	From €14.90	trenitalia.com
Jul	☐ Milan → Monterosso direct	10:35-13:22	Jul/Aug	~€29	trenitalia.com
Aug-Sep	☐ Uffizi Gallery	Oct 7, 08:15 slot	Aug-Sep	~€40	uffizi.it
Aug-Sep	☐ Accademia (David)	Oct 7, 10:30 slot	Aug-Sep	~€12	galleriaaccademiafirenze.it
Aug-Sep	☐ Brunelleschi Pass (Dome)	Oct 7, 11:30 slot	Aug-Sep	€30	duomo.firenze.it
Aug-Sep	☐ Vatican Museums 13:00	Oct 9, 13:00 slot	Aug-Sep	~€22	tickets.museivaticani.va
Aug-Sep	☐ Borghese Gallery 15:00	Oct 10, 15:00 slot	Jul/Aug	~€18	borgnese.gallery
Sep	☐ Colosseum 08:30	Oct 10, 08:30 slot	30 days ahead	€18-24	colosseo.it
Before Sep	☐☐ HFC × 2	Start Oct 1	Anytime	CHF 120	swissrailways.com
Sep	☐ CT → Florence trains	11:25 + 12:19	Sep	~€20-30	trenitalia.com

⚡ Walk-up items: St. Peter's Dome (€10 stairs), Leonardo Express (€14 at station machines)

Half Fare Card — Quick Reference

Item	Full Price	With HFC (50% Off)
HFC Card (one-time, valid 30 days)	—	CHF 120
Buy at:	swissrailways.com → select 2 cards → start Oct 1 → pay → download QR PDF	
Oct 1: ZRH Airport → ZRH HB + city transport	~CHF 20	~CHF 10
Oct 2: Zurich → Lucerne + lake cruise	~CHF 63	~CHF 31.50
Oct 2: Pilatus Golden Round Trip (opt)	~CHF 72	~CHF 36
Oct 3: Lucerne → Interlaken + Grindelwald	~CHF 51	~CHF 25.50
☐ Jungfrauoch (50% off with HFC!)	CHF 261.20	CHF 130.60
Oct 4: Swiss portion to Domodossola	~CHF 30	~CHF 15
TOTAL per person (Relaxed, no Pilatus)		~CHF 332
TOTAL per person (with Pilatus)		~CHF 368

📍 Urban Insights

Zurich is Switzerland's largest city (~430,000) and global financial hub, yet its medieval Old Town (Altstadt) is one of Europe's best-preserved. Founded as the Roman customs post *Turicum* in 15 BC, it joined the Swiss Confederacy in 1351. The city straddles the Limmat River where it meets Lake Zurich, with the iconic twin-towered Grossmünster dominating the skyline. Zurich has been ranked the world's most liveable city multiple times. It's also the birthplace of Dadaism (1916 at the Cabaret Voltaire), the avant-garde art movement that rejected traditional aesthetics.

📌 5 Trivia Facts

- 🐎 **Charlemagne's horse:** Legend claims Grossmünster was founded after Charlemagne's horse stumbled on the graves of Zurich's patron saints, Felix and Regula.
- 🎨 **Chagall at 83:** Marc Chagall created Fraumünster's five stained-glass windows in 1970 at age 83 — his only religious commission.
- 🎭 **The Lindenhof deception:** In 1292, Swiss women dressed as soldiers on Lindenhof hill to trick retreating Habsburgs into thinking reinforcements had arrived.
- 🎭 **Dada was born here:** Cabaret Voltaire (Spiegelgasse 1) launched the Dada art movement in 1916 — a deliberate rejection of logic and reason after WWI.
- 💰 **World's most expensive street:** Bahnhofstrasse is one of the world's most expensive shopping streets, with rents exceeding €7,000/m²/year. The gold bars at the UBS bank windows are real.

🔪 Zurich: Safety & Tips

- 🏠 **INSIDE FIVE:** No front desk. Register **24h before** + passport upload via link. Contact: +41 44 515 49 36
- 👮 **Very safe city.** Low pickpocket risk. Normal caution applies near main station (HB).
- 🚉 **ZRH Airport train station is below Arrivals level 0.** Follow signs to train/IC.

🚆 Local Transit

- 🚉 **ZRH Airport → HB:** **IR/IC trains every 8-10 min** , 14 min, platforms 3/4 below Arrivals
- 🚉 **Zurich HB has 2 levels:** **low level (S-Bahn)** + **high level (IR/IC/EC)**. Lucerne trains from high level.
- 🚊 **Trams 4, 10, 11** from HB to Niederdorf area
- 🕒 **Zurich 24h zone pass:** ~CHF 13 full, **~CHF 6.50 with HFC**

🍽️ Gastronomic Guide

Must-try: Zürcher Geschnetzeltes (veal in cream + mushroom sauce with rösti), Fondue, Raclette, Luxemburgerli (Sprüngli's macarons)
Local specialty: *Bürli* (Zurich-style crusty bread roll), *Züri-Gschnätzlets* with rösti
Budget eats: Coop/Migros ready meals ~CHF 5-8, bakeries (Brezel, pain au chocolat) ~CHF 3-5, kebab shops ~CHF 10-15

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
06:20	☐ LX155 lands	Schengen arrival, customs ~30 min	—
07:10 → 07:24	☐ Train to HB	IR/IC train to Zurich Hauptbahnhof, platforms below Arrivals	50% HFC
08:00 → 08:45	☐ Breakfast @ Sprüngli	Paradeplatz — legendary chocolate café. Try Luxemburgerli macarons (CHF 12-18 for breakfast). Mon-Sat 08:00-18:30.	CHF 12-18
09:00 → 09:30	☐ Lindenhof Viewpoint	Roman fort site → medieval palace → best free Old Town panorama	FREE
10:00 → 10:30	☐ Fraumünster Church	Chagall's 5 stained-glass windows (1970). Mar-Oct 10:00-17:00	CHF 5
10:30 → 11:30	☐ Grossmünster + Tower	Charlemagne's church. 187 steps for 360° Old Town + Alps view.	CHF 5
15:00	☐ Check-in INSIDE FIVE	⚠️ Must register 24h before! No front desk. Contact sent via Booking.com.	—
16:00 → 17:00	☐ Lake Zurich promenade	Towards Zürichhorn — perfect red-eye wind-down	FREE
19:00+	☐ Dinner in Niederdorf	Lively Old Town alleys. Reserve ahead!	CHF 30-50

🍴 Restaurant Recommendations

☐ Sprüngli, Paradeplatz Breakfast, Luxemburgerli, hot chocolate · CHF 12-18 · 08:00-18:30
☐ Zeughauskeller Zürcher Geschnetzeltes, huge portions · CHF 25-40 · Historic armory
☐ Niederdorf alleys Choose from Italian, Swiss, Asian · CHF 15-25 · Reserve a bustling spot
☐ Coop/Migros station Ready meals, salads, sandwiches · CHF 5-8 · Budget lifesaver

🏰 Must-See Attractions

PLACE	WHY IT'S WORTH YOUR TIME
Fraumünster	Marc Chagall's five stained-glass windows depict biblical scenes in dreamlike blue, green, and red. The south transept window (blue) representing "Christ" is the most famous. He created them at age 83 — this was his only major religious commission
Grossmünster	Twin towers legend from Charlemagne's horse. The tower climb gives a 360° view of city, lake, and Alps on clear days. The crypt contains Romanesque columns and Charlemagne's 15th-century statue
Lindenhof	Roman fort (15 BC) → medieval palace → 1292 Habsburg deception. Today: chestnut trees, chess tables, and the best free viewpoint in Zurich
Lake Zurich	Car-free 3km lakeside promenade. Alpine views on clear days. Swans. Perfect jet-lag recovery walk

Urban Insights

Lucerne (Luzern) sits on the shores of Lake Lucerne (Vierwaldstättersee) with the snow-capped Swiss Alps as a dramatic backdrop. Founded in 750 AD, it became a key stop on the Gotthard trade route, which made it one of the wealthiest Swiss cities in the Middle Ages. The Chapel Bridge (Kapellbrücke), Europe's oldest surviving wooden bridge, dates to 1333 and snakes across the Reuss River with 158 triangular 17th-century painted panels depicting Swiss and Lucerne history. The Lion Monument (1821) commemorates the 786 Swiss Guards killed during the 1792 French Revolution — Mark Twain called it "the most mournful and moving piece of stone in the world."

- 5 Trivia Facts

1. **Bridge fire:** The Chapel Bridge was nearly lost to a 1993 fire — 78 of 158 painted panels were destroyed. The surviving 80 originals are in the Alpineum Museum.

2. **Pilatus legend:** Mt. Pilatus is named after Pontius Pilate — legend says his body was thrown into a lake on the mountain, causing storms. It's why locals avoided the summit until the 19th century.

3. **10-metre lion:** The Lion Monument is carved into a 10m × 6m sandstone quarry face. It took Danish sculptor Bertel Thorvaldsen 2 years to design.

4. **Musegg Wall saved the city:** The 870m city wall (1408) had 30 towers originally — 9 survive. It's one of the best-preserved medieval walls in Switzerland and was never breached.

5. **Wagner lived here:** Richard Wagner lived in Lucerne from 1866-1872 and composed *Die Meistersinger von Nürnberg* and *Siegfried* at his Tribtschen villa (now a museum).
- Local Transit

• Zurich → Lucerne: **SBB IR 70** (every 30 min, 41 min, sit LEFT for lake glimpses)

• Pilatus bus: **Bus #1** from station to Kriens gondola base (15 min)

• Lake cruises operated by **SGV Schiff** — check blue/yellow SGV schedules at pier

• Lucerne → Interlaken: **Luzern-Interlaken Express** via Brünig (hourly, 1h55min, **sit RIGHT** for Lake Brienz views)

Gastronomic Guide

Must-try: Swiss fondue (melted Gruyère + Vacherin Fribourgeois), Rösti (crispy shredded potato), Chügelpastete (creamed veal in puff pastry)

Local specialty: Luzerner Lebkuchen (gingerbread), *Luzerner Chügelpastete* — a cream sauce with mushrooms, veal, and chicken in a puff pastry dome

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 08:45	Breakfast + checkout	INSIDE FIVE. Leave bags until check-in.	CHF 10-15
09:10 → 09:51	ZRH HB → Lucerne	SBB IR 70 — every 30 min, 41 min. Sit left for first lake views.	50% HFC
10:15 → 10:45	Chapel Bridge	Europe's oldest wooden bridge (1333). 17th-century painted panels. 2 min from Hotel Alpina.	FREE
10:50 → 11:10	Lion Monument	Mark Twain's "saddest piece of stone." Carved 1821.	FREE
11:15 → 11:45	Weinmarkt Old Town	Medieval squares with painted facades. The most photographed square in Lucerne.	FREE

Afternoon: Choose Your Adventure

OPTION A: Mt. Pilatus Golden Round Trip (clear weather only)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
12:00 → 12:30	Bus #1 → Kriens	From Lucerne station to Kriens gondola base (15 min)	50% HFC
12:30 → 13:00	Gondola → Pilatus Kulm	Panoramic Dragon Ride to 2,132m	~CHF 36
13:00 → 14:00	Summit views	73 mountains visible on clear days. Dragon legends.	Incl.
14:00 → 14:40	Cogwheel → Alpnachstad	Steepest cogwheel (48% grade)! World record holder.	50% HFC
15:00 → 16:15	Boat → Lucerne	Scenic return across Lake Lucerne	50% HFC

OPTION B: Relaxed Lucerne + Lake Cruise (any weather)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
12:00 → 13:00	Lunch on lake promenade	Rathaus Brauerei or Wirtshaus Taube	CHF 25-40
12:12 → 13:00	Cruise → Weggis	SGV paddle steamer — 1h across the lake	50% HFC
13:00 → 13:40	Explore Weggis	Charming lakeside village. Mark Twain spent summers here.	FREE
13:45 → 14:30	Return cruise	45 min back to Lucerne	50% HFC
15:30 → 17:00	Musegg Wall	9 medieval towers, 870m city ramparts. Climb Schirmer, Zyt, or Männli tower.	FREE

Dinner (both options): 19:00+ on lake promenade · CHF 35-50 · **Reserve ahead** ·

Chapel Bridge lit at 21:00

Restaurant Recommendations

Rathaus Brauerei

Brewery since 1863 · Lake terrace · Swiss classics · CHF 25-40

Wirtshaus Taube

Chügelpastete, fondue · CHF 20-35 · Local favorite

Hotel Schweizerhof

Fine dining · Lake terrace · CHF 30-50 · Splurge option

Fondue House du Pont

Best fondue in Lucerne · CHF 25-40 · Yelp #2

Interlaken & Jungfrauojoch

Sat, Oct 3 · 1 night · Hotel Harder Minerva

Urban Insights

Interlaken (literally "between lakes") sits on a strip of flatland between Lake Thun and Lake Brienz, surrounded by the Bernese Alps — it's the adventure capital of Switzerland. **Jungfrauojoch** (3,454m / 11,332ft) is the highest railway station in Europe. The Jungfrau Railway opened in 1912 after **16 years** of construction through the Eiger and Mönch mountains. Workers lived in the tunnel for months, blasting through 7km of rock. Today, the summit has the Sphinx Observation Deck (360° at 3,571m), the Ice Palace (tunnels carved 20m into the glacier), the Aletsch Glacier (23km, UNESCO), and the Chocolate Paradise (free Lindt samples at the highest chocolate shop in the world).

5 Trivia Facts

- 16 years through a mountain:** The Jungfrau Railway took 16 years (1896-1912) through the Eiger and Mönch. Workers lived in the tunnel, slept on straw, and died in explosions.
- Eiger's deadly face:** The Eiger North Face (3,970m) is called "Mordwand" (Murder Wall) — over 60 climbers have died attempting it since 1935. The railway runs right through it.
- Glacier is vanishing:** The Aletsch Glacier (23km, 27 billion tons) has receded 3.6km since 1870 and is losing ~50m/year. It may not exist by 2100.
- Harder Kulm funicular:** The funicular has run since 1908 with a maximum gradient of 64% — one of the steepest in Europe. It's closed for maintenance in 2026.
- Paragliding capital:** Interlaken is one of the world's top paragliding spots — over 20,000 tandem flights annually from Beatenberg and Harder Kulm.

Local Transit

- Lucerne → Interlaken: **Luzern-Interlaken Express** (hourly, 1h55min). **Sit RIGHT** for Lake Brienz. No reservation needed.
- Interlaken Ost → Grindelwald: **Berner Oberland Bahn (BOB)**, 32 min, departures :02/:32
- Grindelwald → Eigergletscher: **Eiger Express 3S cable car** (15 min, glass floor). Latest morning ascent ~15:00
- Jungfrauojoch last descent: ~**16:45** — don't miss it or you're stuck overnight!

Gastronomic Guide

- Must-try:** Rösti (crispy potato), Berner Platte (pork, beef, sausage with sauerkraut), Fondue, Raclette
- Jungfrauojoch:** Panorama Restaurant (11:30-16:00, CHF 20-35 for hot meals), **Chocolate Paradise** (free Lindt samples!)

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 08:45	☐ Breakfast + checkout	Hotel Alpina. Store bags at reception.	CHF 10-15
09:04 → 10:59	☐ Lucerne → Interlaken Ost	Luzern-Interlaken Express via Brünig. !! Sit RIGHT !! for Lake Brienz panorama.	50% HFC
11:00 → 11:15	☐ Drop bags	Harder Minerva, 5 min walk from Ost. Check-in from 15:00.	—
11:30 → 12:15	☐ Quick lunch	Migros near station or station bakery — grab-and-go	CHF 15-25
12:32 → 13:04	☐ Interlaken Ost → Grindelwald	BOB Berner Oberland Bahn , 32 min. Rear of train splits at Zweilütschinen.	50% HFC
13:04 → 13:19	☐ Eiger Express	15 min cable car to Eigergletscher. Glass floor!	Incl.
13:19 → 13:27	☐ Cogwheel to summit	8 min through Eiger tunnel	Incl.
13:27 → 16:30	☐ JUNGFRAUJOCH	3h at the Top of Europe!	CHF 130.60
16:30 → 17:25	☐ ↓ Descent	Jungfrauojoch → Interlaken Ost, ~55 min	Incl.
17:30	☐ Check-in Harder Minerva	Rest after the summit	—
19:00+	☐ Dinner	Reserve ahead!	CHF 30-45

Jungfrauojoch: What to Do in 3 Hours

ATTRACTION	TIME	WHY YOU CAN'T MISS IT
☐ Sphinx Observation Deck	40 min	360° at 3,571m. Aletsch Glacier 23km south. On clear days: France, Germany, Italy visible. Go first!
☐ Ice Palace	20 min	Tunnels carved 20m into the glacier. Blue-lit ice sculptures. -3°C. Slippery floor.
☐ Alpine Sensation	15 min	Multimedia journey of the Jungfrau Railway's 16-year construction. The human story.
☐ Plateau (outdoor)	30 min	Outdoor glacier terrace. Swiss flag photo. Warm layers required!
☐ Chocolate Paradise	15 min	Free Lindt samples at 3,454m! Also: highest chocolate shop in the world.

Restaurant Recommendations

☐ Hirschen (Old Town) Traditional Swiss · CHF 25-40 · 5 min from hotel
☐ Hüsi Bierhaus Hearty meals, good beers · CHF 20-30 · Casual vibe
☐ Jungfrauojoch Panorama Summit dining 11:30-16:00 · CHF 20-35
☐ Migros near Ost Quick lunch · CHF 10-15

Urban Insights

Milan (Milano) is Italy's financial and fashion capital, founded by Insubri Celts as Mediolanum in 600 BC. It became capital of the Western Roman Empire in 286 AD. Under the Sforza dukes (1450-1499), Milan was a Renaissance powerhouse. Leonardo da Vinci spent 17 years here, painting The Last Supper on a refractory wall. The Duomo (started 1386, finished 1965 — 579 years!) is the largest church in Italy and 5th in the world. Milan is also the home of Italy's stock exchange, the La Scala opera house, and the fashion houses Prada, Versace, Armani, and Dolce & Gabbana.

- 5 Trivia Facts

1.

Last Supper's crisis: Leonardo painted The Last Supper in oil-tempera on dry plaster (not true fresco) — a failed experiment. It began deteriorating within his lifetime and has been restored 7 times.

2.

579 years to build: The Duomo took from 1386 to 1965. Napoleon accelerated construction in 1805 just to be crowned King of Italy there.

3.

3,400 statues: The Duomo has 3,400 statues, 135 spires, and 700 gargoyles. The Madonnina (golden Madonna) at 108.5m is a Milanese icon.

4.

Spin the bull's balls: In the Galleria, locals spin their heel on the mosaic bull's testicles for good luck — three spins = guaranteed return to Milan. The hole is worn 20cm deep.

5.

Aperitivo was born here: The first *aperitivo* culture started in Milan in the 19th century — Campari was created here in 1860. Today, buying a drink gets you a free buffet dinner.

Milan Security Matrix

Risk: Medium. Pickpocket hotspots: Duomo square, Galleria, metro M1/M3, Centrale station, tram #1

"Friendship bracelet" scam:

Men tie bracelets on you near Duomo, then demand €10-20. Shake them off and walk fast.

Fake charity petitions:

Someone blocks your path with a clipboard, asks you to sign, then demands €10-20 donation. Keep walking.

Last Supper ticket touts:

Resellers charge €50-100 for €15 tickets. **Only buy from [cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it](#)**

Taxi scam:

Only take official white taxis with meters from taxi ranks. Never accept rides from touts at the station.

Local Transit

• Milano Centrale has **M2** (green) + **M3** (yellow) metro

• Last Supper area: **M1 Cadorna** or **M2 Sant'Ambrogio** (5 min walk)

• Duomo area: **M1 (red)** or **M3 (yellow)** to Duomo station

• Single metro ticket: €2.20, 24h pass: €7.60. Validate at turnstiles.

Gastronomic Guide

Must-try: Risotto alla Milanese (saffron risotto), Cotoletta alla Milanese (breaded veal cutlet), Ossobuco (braised veal shank), Panettone (originally Milanese!)

Aperitivo: Campari, Negroni (invented in Florence but perfected in Milan), Aperol Spritz

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 09:00	Breakfast + checkout	Harder Minerva, relaxed pace.	CHF 10-15
09:33 → 12:48	Interlaken → Milano	EC 61 EuroCity (via Spiez → Brig → Domodossola). Crosses into Italy at Domodossola. Book Jul!	From €23
12:48 → 13:30	Drop bags	Metro to hotel or walk from Centrale	—
13:30 → 14:15	Lunch near SMG	Quick pasta near Santa Maria delle Grazie	€12-20
14:30 → 14:45	Arrive SMG	30 min before slot. Photo ID required to pick up tickets.	—
15:00 → 15:15	THE LAST SUPPER	Book late Jun/Jul! 15 min with the world's most famous painting. No flash.	€15
15:30 → 15:50	Walk to Duomo	Via Torino (20 min)	FREE
16:00 → 17:00	Duomo Rooftop	Stairs €13 (250 steps). Golden hour! Last entry 18:00.	€13
17:00 → 18:00	Duomo Interior	5 naves, 3,400 statues. St. Bartholomew's flayed skin statue.	€3
18:00 → 19:00	Galleria Vittorio Emanuele	Spin the bull's balls! Top terrace: €12.	FREE/€12
19:00+	Dinner	Navigli canals (M2 Porta Genova) — Sunday aperitivo culture!	€25-40

The Last Supper — Booking Guide

FACT	DETAILS
Where	Refectory of Santa Maria delle Grazie. Piazza di Santa Maria delle Grazie, M1 Cadorna or M2 Sant'Ambrogio.
When to book	Late June / Early July 2026. Quarterly release covers Sep-Dec. Check Wednesdays at 12:00 Italian time on cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it. Sells out in hours.
What you get	Exactly 15 minutes. Groups of 30-40 every 15 min. Strict security. No photography with flash. No large bags.
What you see	Jesus says "one of you will betray me" — each apostle reacts differently. Revolutionary composition: all perspective lines converge on Christ's head (single vanishing point).

Restaurant Recommendations

- Luini (Via S. Antonio)

Famous fried panzerotti · ~€5 · Queue moves fast. Must-try!
- Miscusi (various)

Modern pasta chain · ~€12-18 · Fresh made daily
- Trattoria Trippa

Best Milanese by Chef Rossi · ~€30-45 · Book via website!
- Navigli restaurants

Aperitivo culture · drink + free buffet · €10-15

 Cinque Terre

Mon-Tue, Oct 5-6 · 1 night · Monterosso al Mare (TBD)

 Urban Insights

The "Five Lands" — Monterosso, Vernazza, Corniglia, Manarola, Riomaggiore — are five medieval fishing villages clinging to the rugged Ligurian coast, a UNESCO World Heritage site since 1997. No cars reach the villages (except Monterosso). The **Sentiero Azzurro** (Blue Trail) connects all five in a 12km coastal hike. Each village has its own personality — Monterosso (beach resort, the only proper sandy beach), Vernazza (picturesque harbor, most photogenic), Corniglia (clifftop, 377 steps from the station), Manarola (sunset views, leaning tower), Riomaggiore (steep and colorful, Cinque Terre's postcard). Local specialties: pesto alla genovese (basil, pine nuts, parmesan, olive oil — no cream!), trofie pasta, focaccia (originated in Liguria!), and Sciacchetrà dessert wine.

 5 Trivia Facts

- Wine terraces:** The iconic terraced vineyards on the cliffs were built by hand over 800 years — the stone walls total 6,730km (longer than the Great Wall of China's main line).
- No cars:** The villages are almost entirely car-free. The only car traffic is in Monterosso. Everything else is train, boat, or foot.
- Via dell'Amore:** The "Lover's Lane" between Riomaggiore and Manarola is a clifftop path built for railway workers in the 1920s. It's been closed since a 2023 landslide.
- Anchovy capital:** Monterosso is famous for its anchovies — salted and preserved in oil. You see them hanging in market signs everywhere.
- Focaccia was born here:** Liguria is the birthplace of focaccia — the flat, oil-brushed bread. The original Genovese version is soft, salty, and perfect with pesto.

 Cinque Terre Safety

- ⚠ **NO left luggage** at any CT station! Confirm bag drop with Monterosso hotel.
- ✅ **Validate regional train tickets** in green machines before boarding (or buy via app with QR)
- Sentiero Azzurro: proper shoes + water. 90 min moderate difficulty.
- CT Card** (€7.50) needed for the hiking trail + includes unlimited local train rides.

 Local Transit

- Milan → Monterosso: **Direct train 10:35-13:22** (7-8 direct per day). Reg or IC. Book on trenitalia.com
- CT Express trains run every 20 min between villages (7-10 min between stops)
- Monterosso → La Spezia: **11:25-11:45 CT Express** (20 min). **34 min buffer** before Frecciarossa
- La Spezia → Florence SMN: **Frecciarossa 12:19-13:47** (1h 28min). Top speed 300km/h.

 Day 5: Mon Oct 5 — Arrival + Afternoon

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
10:35 → 13:22	 Milan → Monterosso	Direct train. Sit RIGHT after Genova for coastal views!	~€29
13:30 → 14:30	 Check-in + lunch	⚠ Confirm bag drop with hotel. No left luggage at stations!	€15-25

OPTION A: Monterosso Beach + Old Town

14:30-16:30	Monterosso's sandy beach + Old Town lanes
16:30-17:30	 Gelato + passeggiata

OPTION B: Hike Monterosso → Vernazza

14:30-16:00	Sentiero Azzurro, 90 min coastal hike
16:00-16:40	Explore Vernazza harbor + sunset views

Dinner: 19:00+ · Monterosso harbour seafood or **Da Miky** (best in CT · book ahead!) · €20-35

 Day 6: Tue Oct 6 — Morning Hike → Florence

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:30 → 10:00	 Morning Hike	Monterosso → Vernazza on Sentiero Azzurro. Morning light = ☑. 90 min, moderate.	€7.50
10:00 → 10:20	 Vernazza morning	Last look at the colorful harbor	FREE
10:20 → 10:30	 CT Express back	Vernazza → Monterosso	CT Card
10:30 → 11:00	 Checkout + walk to station	Pack and leave Monterosso	—
11:25 → 11:45	 Monterosso → La Spezia	!! Earlier train = 34 min buffer before Frecciarossa !!	CT Card
12:19 → 13:47	 La Spezia → Firenze SMN	Frecciarossa high-speed to Florence! 34 min to find platform.	~€20-30

 Restaurant Recommendations

 Da Miky (Monterosso)

Best seafood in CT · ~€25-40 · Book ahead! 

 Belforte (Vernazza)

Suspended over harbour · squid ink pasta · ~€20-35

 Nessun Dorma (Vernazza)

Sunset terrace · wines + focaccia · ~€15-20

 Pizza Kepris (Monterosso)

Budget eats · ~€5-8

 Florence

Tue-Thu, Oct 6-8 · 2 nights · TBD (near SMN or Duomo)

 Urban Insights

Florence (Firenze) is the cradle of the Renaissance. In the 15th century, the Medici family transformed this Tuscan city into the most culturally explosive place on Earth. In a single generation: Brunelleschi built the Dome (the largest masonry dome ever — no scaffolding!), Donatello sculpted David, Masaccio revolutionized painting, and a young Leonardo da Vinci apprenticed in Verrocchio's workshop. Then came Michelangelo, Raphael, and Botticelli. The Uffizi Gallery has the world's finest Renaissance collection. Florence also has a local law requiring restaurants to source at least 70% of ingredients from Tuscany. Florentines *care* about their food.

 5 Trivia Facts

- Dome without scaffolding:** Brunelleschi's Dome was built with a revolutionary herringbone brick pattern that supports itself — no external scaffolding. He won the commission by making an egg stand on end.
- David's rejected marble:** Michelangelo's David was carved from a single block of Carrara marble that TWO earlier sculptors had rejected as flawed ("Il Gigante"). Michelangelo was 26.
- Ponte Vecchio survived WWII:** It's the only Florentine bridge the Nazis didn't destroy in 1944. Hitler personally ordered it spared because of its beauty.
- Pepso pepper stew:** Peposo (beef slow-cooked in black pepper) has Renaissance origins — Brunelleschi's workers ate it during Dome construction. The pepper was a cheap flavor substitute for salt (which was taxed).
- Church dress code:** Florence's churches enforce strict dress codes — shoulders and knees covered. The Duomo has security guards at every entrance. No exceptions.

 Florence Security Matrix

- Risk: Medium-high.** Pickpocket: Duomo square, Uffizi queue, Santa Croce, packed markets
-  **Bracelet scam:** Aggressive men near Duomo tie bracelets on you, demand €10-20. Shake them off.
 -  **Gold ring scam:** Someone "finds" a gold ring near you, accomplice lifts your bag while you look.
 -  **Unofficial taxis:** Only white taxis with meters from official ranks. No ride-hailing from touts.

 Local Transit

- Florence is **walkable** — most sights within 20 min of SMN station
- Bus 131R to Siena: from **Autostazione (behind SMN)**, not SMN. Via Santa Caterina da Siena 17
- Firenze SMN → Roma Termini: **Frecciarossa every 15-30 min**, 1h 28min, booked via trenitalia.com

 Oct 6 (Tue) — Arrival + Evening

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
14:00 → 14:30	 Check-in	Near SMN or Duomo	—
15:00 → 16:00	 Santa Croce	Tombs of Michelangelo, Galileo, Machiavelli . Closes 17:30.	€12
16:00 → 16:40	 Ponte Vecchio	Photo stop. Jewelry-lined medieval bridge built 1345.	FREE
17:00 → 17:45	 San Miniato al Monte	GO FIRST! Romanesque, green-white marble. Closes 18:00 . Plainsong chant ~17:30.	FREE
17:45 → 18:30	 Piazzale Michelangelo	SUNSET ~18:11  Classic Florence panorama. Bring a bottle of wine!	FREE
19:00+	 Dinner in Oltrarno	Reserve ahead — authentic Tuscan	€20-35

 Oct 7 (Wed) — Full Florence Art Day

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:15 → 10:15	 UFFIZI GALLERY	First slot = least crowded! Botticelli, Leonardo, Caravaggio, Raphael. Book Aug-Sep!	~€40
10:30 → 11:15	 ACCADEMIA — David	Michelangelo's David! 45 min enough. Pre-book 10:30 slot.	~€12
11:30 → 12:30	 DOME CLIMB	463 steps! No elevator. Emerge inches from Vasari's Last Judgment fresco. Brunelleschi Pass €30	€30
12:30 → 13:00	 Duomo Interior	Free. Vasari's Last Judgment. Shoulders + knees covered.	FREE
13:00 → 14:00	 LUNCH @ Mercato Centrale	Upper floor food hall — 20+ stalls. €10-18 feast!	€10-18
14:00 → 15:30	 Oltrarno Walk	Ponte Vecchio → Palazzo Pitti → Santo Spirito → Via Maggio	FREE/€5
15:30 → 16:30	 San Lorenzo Market	Leather goods, souvenirs	FREE
17:00 → 18:00	 San Miniato (backup)	Closes 18:00. Plainsong at 17:30.	FREE
19:00+	 Final Florence Dinner	Try Bistecca alla Fiorentina in Oltrarno! Reserve ahead.	€20-35

 Uffizi Gallery Room Guide

ROOM	MASTERPIECE	WHAT TO KNOW
Room 10-14	Botticelli — Birth of Venus, Spring	First large-scale non-religious nude since antiquity (1486). The most famous room in the gallery.
Room 15	Leonardo — Annunciation, Adoration	Leonardo's first major work at age 20. Note the angel wings — he repainted them.
Room 25	Michelangelo — Doni Tondo	The only easel painting by Michelangelo still in Florence. Original circular frame.
Room 90	Caravaggio — Medusa, Bacchus	Medusa painted on a wooden shield. Caravaggio used his own face as the model.

 Restaurant Recommendations

 All'Antico Vinaio

Famous €8 sandwich · Queue always long · Worth it!

 Mercato Centrale

Upper floor · 20+ food stalls · €10-18 · Great variety

 Ditta Artigianale

Specialty coffee · ~€4-6 · Oltrarno · Best espresso in Florence

 Trattoria Nella

Local favorite · Simple Tuscan · ~€15-25 · Quirky owner

 Osteria Pepo (Mercato Centrale)

Traditional Tuscan · decent prices · ~€15-25

 Gelato

Gelateria dei Neri or Perchè No! · ~€4-7

Urban Insights

Siena is a perfectly preserved medieval city — Florence's great rival in artistry, politics, and pride. The shell-shaped Piazza del Campo is Europe's finest medieval square. Twice a year, it hosts the Palio, a bareback horse race lasting 90 seconds that's been run since 1147. Seventeen *contrade* (neighborhoods) compete — the rivalry is life and death. The Duomo's mosaic floor took 200 years to complete. The Piccolomini Library has frescoes by Pinturicchio that rival the Sistine Chapel. Siena's entire historic center is UNESCO-listed.

5 Trivia Facts

1.

The Palio is brutal: The Palio horse race has been run since 1147 — bareback, 3 laps around the sloping Piazza del Campo. The jockeys don't ride to win; their only goal is to stop their rivals.
2.

Siena almost beat Florence: In 1260, Siena defeated Florence at the Battle of Montaperti. The rivalry continued for 300 years — Florence finally annexed Siena in 1555.
3.

Unfinished masterpiece: Siena's Duomo was meant to be the largest church in Christendom — the existing nave would have been the transept. The Black Death of 1348 halved the population and stopped construction.
4.

Mosaic floor took 200 years: The Duomo's 56-panel mosaic floor took from 1369 to 1547 to complete. It's usually covered except for September and October.
5.

Taverna di Cinta: Siena's city walls (Cinta Senese) are 7km long with 7 gates — one of the best-preserved medieval fortifications in Italy.
- | TIME | ACTIVITY | DETAILS | COST |
|---------------|---|---|--------------------|
| 07:00 → 08:00 | <div><div></div> Breakfast + store bags</div> | Leave luggage at Florence hotel. Return to collect after Siena. | — |
| 08:30 → 09:45 | <div><div></div> Bus 131R → Siena</div> | From Autostazione (behind SMN). ⚠ Arrive 10 min early — buses fill up! | €7-9 |
| 10:00 → 10:30 | <div><div></div> Piazza del Campo</div> | Shell-shaped square. Palio runs here. Torre del Mangia towers above. | FREE |
| 10:30 → 11:30 | <div><div></div> Siena Duomo</div> | Mosaic floor (56 panels) + Piccolomini Library frescoes <div></div> | €10-15 |
| 11:30 → 12:15 | <div><div></div> Torre del Mangia</div> | 400 steps for panoramic Siena + Tuscan countryside | €10 |
| 12:15 → 13:00 | <div><div></div> Lunch</div> | Pici cacio e pepe (Siena's thick spaghetti) | €10-15 |
| 13:30 → 14:45 | <div><div></div> Bus 131R → Florence</div> | ⚠ Walk uphill takes time. Be at stop by 13:15! | €7-9 |
| 14:45 → 15:10 | <div><div></div> Collect luggage</div> | Walk to hotel, grab bags | — |
| 16:00 → 17:28 | <div><div></div> Frecciarossa → Rome</div> | Firenze SMN → Roma Termini. 1h 28min, 300km/h. Book Jul 2026! | From €14.90 |
| 17:30 → 18:00 | <div><div></div> Check-in Rome</div> | Home base for 4 nights | — |
| 19:00 → 20:00 | <div><div></div> Trevi Fountain (night)</div> | Lit up after dark <div></div> — fewer crowds, magic atmosphere | FREE |

Urban Insights

For over 1,000 years, Rome was the center of the Western world. The Colosseum (80 AD) held 50,000 spectators. The Roman Forum was the political heart of the Republic. Vatican City (44 hectares, ~800 citizens) is the smallest independent state on Earth — and holds the world's greatest art collection, amassed by popes over 500 years. Rome isn't a city, it's a live museum: layer upon layer of Roman, medieval, Renaissance, and Baroque history built on top of each other. Walking through Rome is walking through 2,800 years of continuous civilization.

5 Trivia Facts

Colosseum's 80 entrances:

Bernini at 22:

Vatican Museums = 12 years:

Trevi's 80,000m³:

Pantheon's perfect dome:

Rome Security Matrix

Risk: High.

Colosseum ticket touts:

Gladiator photos:

Vatican "official guides":

Rosary scam:

Local Transit

Metro:

Single metro ticket:

Leonardo Express:

Gastronomic Guide

Must-try:

Testaccio neighborhood

Oct 9 (Fri) — Vatican Day

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
06:30 – 07:00	Early breakfast	Hotel or nearby café. Start early for empty St. Peter's.	—
07:00 – 07:30	St. Peter's Basilica	Opens 07:00 — no queue! FREE. See: Michelangelo's Pietà (his only signed work), Bernini's baldachin. Dress code: shoulders + knees.	FREE
07:30 – 08:15	St. Peter's Dome	551 steps. Elevator €15 (saves 231) or stairs €10. ⚠ Oct hours: 07:30-17:00 (not 07:00!). Do it early — no queue!	€10/€15
08:15 – 08:45	Crypt/Grottoes	Tomb of St. Peter, papal tombs beneath the basilica. 07:00-17:00.	FREE
09:00 – 09:30	Castel Sant'Angelo ext.	Hadrian's mausoleum (139 AD). Walk along Tiber.	FREE
09:30 – 10:30	Via della Conciliazione → Piazza Navona	The grand boulevard leading to St. Peter's → beautiful approach	FREE
10:30 – 11:30	Piazza Navona	Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers (Nile, Ganges, Danube, Río de la Plata)	FREE
11:30 – 12:00	Pantheon	Best preserved Roman building. Open oculus — rain falls through!	€5
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch near Vatican	Quick pasta	€12-20
13:00 – 17:30	VATICAN MUSEUMS	4.5h ☐ Pre-book 13:00 slot. Sistine Chapel (last 30 min), Raphael Rooms, Gallery of Maps. Book Aug-Sep!	~€22
17:45 – 18:15	St. Peter's Square	Evening light on Bernini's colonnade (284 columns)	FREE
19:00+	Dinner in Trastevere	Reserve ahead! Cobblestone alleys, ivy-covered restaurants. Roman classics: cacio e pepe, carbonara.	€25-40

Oct 10 (Sat) — Ancient Rome Day

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:30 – 10:30	COLOSSEUM	First slot = cooler + less crowded! Arena floor upgrade (€24) lets you stand where gladiators fought. ☐ Worth it. Pre-book Sep.	€18/24
10:30 – 12:00	Forum + Palatine Hill	Arch of Titus, Via Sacra, Senate House, Temple of Caesar, Domus Augustana	Incl.
12:00 – 12:15	Via dei Fori Imperiali	Looking down at Roman excavations	FREE
12:15 – 12:45	Trevi Fountain (day)	Throw a coin with right hand over left shoulder ☐	FREE
12:45 – 13:45	Lunch	Trevi/Spanish Steps area	€12-20
14:00 – 14:40	Walk to Borghese	Through Villa Borghese park (80 hectares, Rome's green lung)	FREE
14:40	Arrive Borghese	⚠ 20 min early! No late entry. Max 360 people per 2h slot.	—
15:00 – 17:00	BORGHESE GALLERY	Bernini's Apollo & Daphne (marble transforms into leaves), Rape of Proserpina, Caravaggio's Medusa. Book Jul/Aug!	~€18
17:30 – 19:00	Spanish Steps + Via Veneto	Dolce Vita walk. Climb Spanish Steps for sunset over Rome.	FREE
19:30+	Dinner	Trastevere or Testaccio	€25-40

🏠

Last Day in Rome

Your decompression day. The **Aventine Keyhole** is Rome's best secret — look through the keyhole of the Knights of Malta gate and see St. Peter's Dome perfectly framed. The **Orange Garden** (Giardino degli Aranci) has the best free sunset view. This is where you slow down, eat well, and absorb the city that 2,800 years built.

🏠

Rome Restaurant Recommendations

🏠

Da Enzo (Trastevere)

Characteristic Roman trattoria · ~€25-35 · Reserve!

🏠

Agustarello (Testaccio)

Best cacio e pepe in Rome · family-run · ~€20-30

🏠

Pastificio (near Trevi)

€4 takeaway pasta · Great budget option

🏠

Gelateria del Teatro

Artisanal gelato · ~€4-7 · Near Piazza Navona

🏠

Flavio al Velavevodetto (Testaccio)

Amatriciana legend · ~€25-40 · Reserve!

🏠

Tempio di Iside

Elegant fish · near Colosseum · ~€25-40

🏠 Oct 11 (Sun) — Relaxed Final Day

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
08:00 → 09:00	🏠 Breakfast + checkout	Store luggage at hotel.	—
09:30 → 10:00	🏠 Trevi Fountain (morning)	Fewer people + morning light 🏠 Better photos than evening crowds.	FREE
10:00 → 11:00	🏠 Spanish Steps + Via Condotti	Window-shopping at luxury stores. Highest-end fashion.	FREE
11:00 → 12:00	☕ Last caffè	People-watching at a sidewalk café. One last espresso.	€5-10
13:00 → 14:30	🏠 Aventine Keyhole	Knights of Malta — look through the keyhole for a perfectly framed St. Peter's. Then Orange Garden (Giardino degli Aranci) — best free Rome view 🏠.	FREE
14:30 → 16:00	🏠 Last passeggiata	One final walk. Piazza Navona? Trastevere? Your choice.	FREE
17:00 → 18:00	🏠 Collect luggage	Back to hotel	—
19:00+	🏠 FINAL DINNER	Splurge! Reserve the best table in Trastevere. Cacio e pepe, carbonara, amatriciana. Finish with limoncello. 🏠🏠 You've earned this.	€30-45

➔ Oct 12 (Mon) — Departure

TIME	ACTIVITY	DETAILS	COST
07:30 → 08:00	🏠 One last cappuccino	Breakfast only — never after 11am! (Italian rule)	—
08:00 → 09:00	🏠 Last souvenirs	Final walk, last-minute shopping	—
09:00 → 09:15	🏠 Walk to Termini	From most central hotels, 15 min walk	—
09:20 → 09:52	🏠 Leonardo Express ➔ FCO	Non-stop to Fiumicino Airport. Every 15 min. Buy ticket at Termini machines (€14). Keep ticket until you exit FCO.	€14
10:00 → 12:40	🏠 Check-in + Security	At gate by ~11:45. 2h 40min buffer — comfortable.	—
12:40	➔ GF26 ➔ BAH (19:20)	Gulf Air to Bahrain. PNR: UYWIKY. Layover BAH 22:45-02:35.	Booked
02:35 → 05:10+1	🏠 GF56 ➔ BOM	Arrive Mumbai Tue Oct 13, 05:10 IST 🏠	Booked

12 days · 8 cities · 2 countries · The trip of a lifetime. 🏠🏠🏠

🏠 Exact Train Numbers Reference

#	ROUTE	TRAIN	TIME	DURATION
1	ZRH Airport ➔ ZRH HB	IR / IC (any)	07:10-07:24	14 min
2	Zurich HB ➔ Lucerne	SBB IR 70	09:10-09:51	41 min
3	Lucerne ➔ Interlaken Ost	Luzern-Interlaken Express	09:04-10:59	1h 55min
4	Interlaken Ost ➔ Grindelwald	BOB Berner Oberland Bahn	12:32-13:04	32 min
5	Grindelwald ➔ Eigergletscher	Eiger Express (cable car)	13:04-13:19	15 min
6	Eigergletscher ➔ Jungfrauoch	Cogwheel train	13:19-13:27	8 min
7	Interlaken Ost ➔ Milano Centrale	EC 61 EuroCity	09:33-12:48	3h 15min
8	Milano Centrale ➔ Monterosso	Direct IC/Regionale Veloce	10:35-13:22	~3h
9	Monterosso ➔ La Spezia	CT Express (Regionale)	11:25-11:45	20 min
10	La Spezia ➔ Firenze SMN	Frecciarossa	12:19-13:47	1h 28min
11	Firenze SMN ➔ Roma Termini	Frecciarossa	16:00-17:28	1h 28min
12	Roma Termini ➔ FCO Airport	Leonardo Express	09:20-09:52	32 min

Master Booking Reference

Flight Bookings

LEG	FLIGHT	ROUTE	DATE	TIME	PNR	TICKET #	COST
Outbound	SWISS LX155	BOM → ZRH	Oct 1	00:40-06:20	Z5DY9C	7242907276239/40	₹77,625
Return L1	Gulf Air GF26	FCO → BAH	Oct 12	12:40-19:20	UYWIKY	0724857463386/7	₹69,372
Return L2	Gulf Air GF56	BAH → BOM	Oct 12 → 13	02:35-05:10	UYWIKY	0724857463386/7	
Total flights						₹1,46,997 for 2 pax	

Hotel Bookings

#	DATE	CITY	HOTEL	STATUS	COST	REF	NOTES
1	Oct 1	Zurich	INSIDE FIVE City Apartments Motorenstrasse 11	☐ Booked	₹12,375	Booking.com	Non-refundable. ⚠ Register 24h before! Passport upload needed. No front desk.
2	Oct 2	Lucerne	Hotel Alpina Frankenstrasse 6	☐ Booked	₹18,748	Booking.com	Non-refundable. 2 min walk to Chapel Bridge. Check-in from 14:00-15:00.
3	Oct 3	Interlaken	Hotel Harder Minerva Harderstrasse 15	☐ Booked	₹21,562	Booking.com	Free cancel till Sep 19. 5 min from Interlaken Ost station. Next to Harder Kulm funicular.
4	Oct 4	Milan	TBD	☐	~₹35,000	—	Near Duomo or Centrale. 1 night only.
5	Oct 5	Monterosso	TBD	☐	~₹16,000	—	⚠ Confirm morning bag drop. CT stations have NO left luggage. Hotel Marina (🏠9.1) recommended.
6	Oct 6-7	Florence	TBD (2 nights)	☐	~₹62,000	—	Near SMN or Duomo. Same hotel both nights.
7	Oct 8-11	Rome	TBD (4 nights)	☐	~₹96,000	—	Same hotel all 4 nights. Near Termini or city center. Residenza Torre Colonna (🏠9.4) recommended.
Booked Total			3 Swiss hotels		₹52,685	(of ~ ₹57,186 incl. INSIDE FIVE paid ₹12,375)	
Est. Total			All 11 nights		est. ₹2.3-2.7L	(Swiss + Italian hotels)	
⚠ INSIDE FIVE Zurich: This is a self-check-in apartment. They will send a link via Booking.com ~24h before arrival. You MUST upload your passport photos through the link. Contact number: +41 44 515 49 36. If you don't register, you won't get the door code.							

Museum Booking Links

MUSEUM	DATE + SLOT	OFFICIAL LINK	BOOK BY	COST/PP
☐ Last Supper (Cenacolo Vinciano)	Oct 4, 15:00	cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it	☐ Late Jun/Jul	€15
☐ Uffizi Gallery	Oct 7, 08:15	uffizi.it	Aug-Sep	~€40
☐ Accademia (David)	Oct 7, 10:30	galleriaaccademiafirenze.it	Aug-Sep	~€12
☐ Brunelleschi Pass (Dome)	Oct 7, 11:30	duomo.firenze.it	Aug-Sep	€30
☐ Vatican Museums	Oct 9, 13:00	tickets.museivaticani.va	Aug-Sep	~€22
☐ Borghese Gallery	Oct 10, 15:00	borgnese.gallery	Jul/Aug	~€18
☐ Colosseum (Arena)	Oct 10, 08:30	colosseo.it	Sep	€18/€24

Train Booking Links

ROUTE	TRAIN	OFFICIAL LINK	BEST PRICE	BOOK WHEN
Interlaken → Milan	EC 61	trenitalia.com	From €23	Jul 2026
Milan → Monterosso	Direct IC/RV	trenitalia.com	~€29	Jul/Aug
La Spezia → Florence	Frecciarossa	trenitalia.com	~€20-30	Sep
Florence → Rome	Frecciarossa	trenitalia.com	From €14.90	Jul 2026
Rome → FCO	Leonardo Express	Station machines	€14 fixed	Walk-up

Half Fare Card Purchase

Where	swissrailways.com/en/buy-swiss-half-fare-card
What	2 × Half Fare Cards (one for each traveler)
Start date	October 1, 2026
Cost	CHF 120 per person (~₹11,280 each)
How	Buy anytime before Sep 2026. Receive PDF with QR code via email. Save on phone. Add to SBB Mobile app.
How it works	Open SBB App → search route → select "Half Fare Card" → price drops 50% → pay → show ticket QR + HFC QR to inspector

Data verified from official sources (May 28, 2026): cenacolovinciano.org · museivaticani.va · basilicasanpietro.va · uffizi.it · colosseo.it · myswissalps.com · italiarail.com · jungfrau.ch · trenitalia.com · swissrailways.com · timeout.com · eater.com

Oct 2026 times use 2025 schedule patterns. Verify on SBB/Trenitalia ~90 days before travel.
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